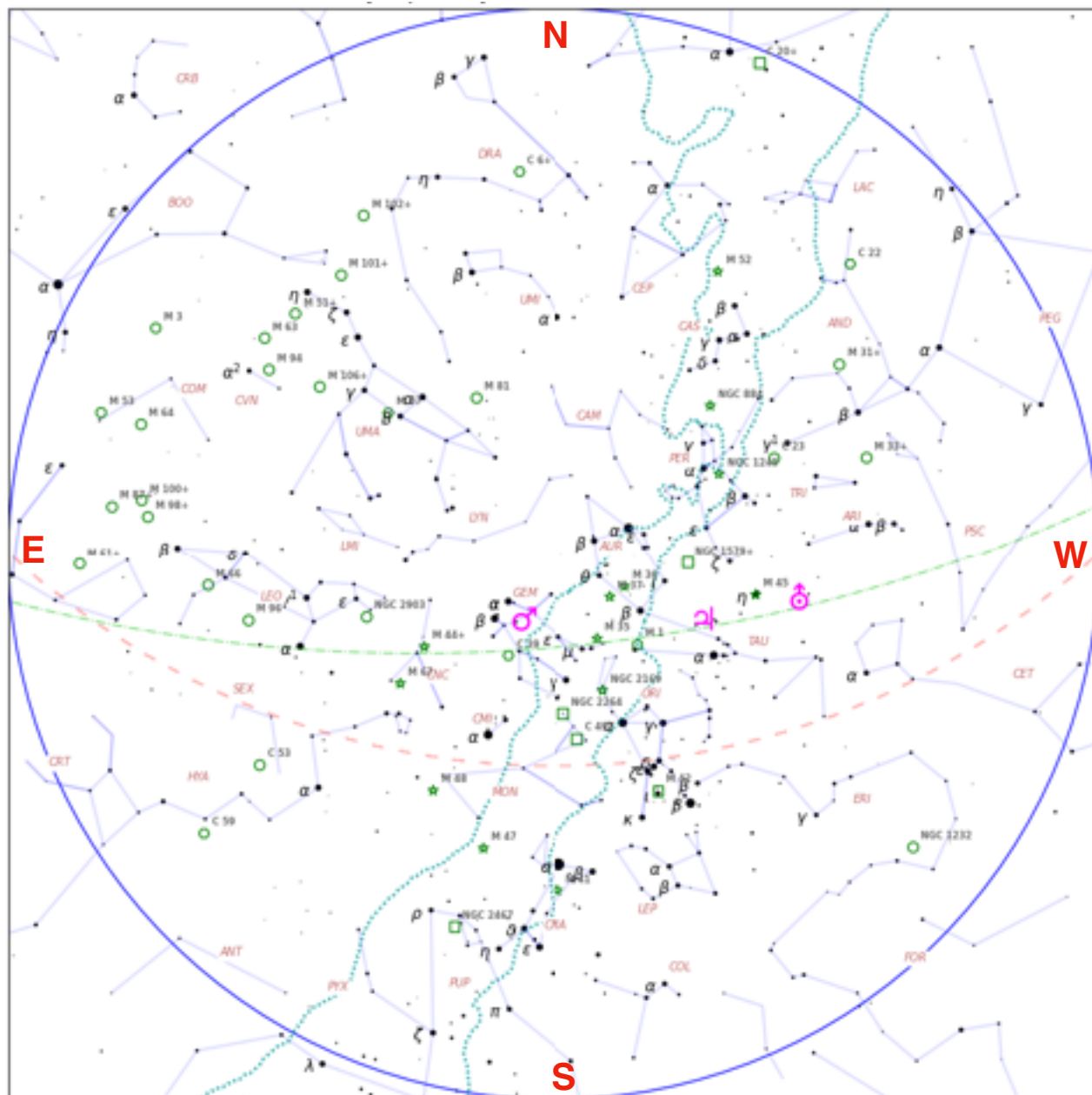


FEBRUARY 2025



The Northern Berkshire Astronomical Society

Meets the first Wednesday of every month, at the
North Adams Public Library at 6 PM.

74 Church St. North Adams MA

Late Winter

Mars and Jupiter dominate the evening sky, both almost overhead. The Winter constellations surrounding Orion take center stage, but signs of the Spring Constellations (with thousands of galaxies) are rising in the East!

Constellations

AND - Andromeda - *the Chained Maiden*
 ANT - Antlia - *the Air Pump*
 ARI - Aries - *the Ram*
 AUR - Auriga - *the Charioteer*
 BOO - Boötes - *the Herdsman*
 CAM - Camelopardalis - *the Giraffe*
 CAS - Cassiopeia - *the Queen of Ethiopia*
 CEP - Cepheus - *the King of Ethiopia*
 CET - Cetus - *the Whale*
 CMA - Canis Major - *the Greater Dog*
 CMI - Canis Minor - *the Lesser Dog*
 CNC - Cancer - *the Crab*
 COL - Columba - *the Dove*
 COM - Coma Berenices - *Berenice's Hair*
 CRB - Corona Borealis - *the Northern Crown*
 CRT - Crater - *the Cup*
 CVN - Canes Venatici - *the Hunting Dogs*
 DRA - Draco - *the Dragon*
 ERI - Eridanus - *the River*
 FOR - Fornax - *the Furnace*
 GEM - Gemini - *the Twins*
 HYA - Hydra - *the Water Snake*
 LAC - Lacerta - *the Lizard*
 LEO - Leo - *the Lion*
 LEP - Lepus - *the Hare*
 LMI - Leo Minor - *the Lesser Lion*
 LYN - Lynx - *the Lynx*
 MON - Monoceros - *the Unicorn*
 ORI - Orion - *the Hunter*
 PEG - Pegasus - *the Winged Horse*
 PER - Perseus - *the Hero*
 PSC - Pisces - *the Fish*
 PUP - Puppis - *the Stern (of Argo)*
 PYX - Pyxis - *the Mariner's Compass*
 SEX - Sextans - *the Sextant*
 TAU - Taurus - *the Bull*
 TRI - Triangulum - *the Triangle*
 UMA - Ursa Major - *the Great Bear*
 UMI - Ursa Minor - *the Lesser Bear*
 VIR - Virgo - *the Maiden*

How to Use the Chart

South is at the bottom, if you hold the chart “up” against the sky, facing South, then East will be to your left and West to the right. (Or if you hold the map upside-down and face North, East will be to the right, West to the left.)

On the chart, the orange dashed line shows the celestial Equator; the green dashed-dotted line the Ecliptic. The Milky Way is outlined with a blue dotted line.

Date	Time
Feb 1	10:00 PM (EST)
Feb 8	9:30 PM
Feb 15	9:00 PM
Feb 22	8:30 PM
Mar 1	8:00 PM

Because of the Earth's motion around the Sun, the time for this chart changes slowly over time, roughly 1/2 hour earlier every week:

Planets

Venus is in Aquarius, visible after sunset.

Jupiter in Taurus - nearly overhead in the early evening.

Mars in Gemini close to the stars Castor and Pollux

Uranus in binoculars or a small telescope SW of the Pleiades in Taurus.